

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON • CAPSTONE 6 OF 6

Lead Your AI Squad



A 45-minute capstone. The hook: an AI agent is a party member — capable, tireless, extremely literal. Party leaders don't redo the squad's work; they write the quest card, assign the roles, and check the loot. Stands alone; no earlier lesson required.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Run the Quest worksheet (1 per student); loose-leaf for squad outputs	None — fully unplugged by design	Print worksheets. Plan teams of 3. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can write a complete **quest card** (goal · what we know · rules of the run · done looks like) that a literal-minded agent could follow without guessing.
- Students can split a project into **squad roles** (planner, scout, critic) and execute a role from the quest card alone.
- Students can review work against the **CHECK rubric** (accuracy, taste, done-ness) and write a specific run-it-back note.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.7.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

Full text, with where each is taught and assessed, in the Teacher Guide.

✓ WARM-UP — IT DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID (7 MIN)

Tell the class about your new party member: maxed-out stats, never sleeps, never complains — and painfully literal. Three orders from last night's run:

"Guard the door." → Guarded the door. Only the door. The enemies came in through the window.

"Grab everything in the chest." → Everything. Including the cursed amulet with the obvious skull on it.

"Wait here." → Still waiting. It has been three in-game days.

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the party member's, or the orders?** (Lesson 1 alumni will call it: this party member IS the literal genie — it just joined your squad. New classes need no backstory.)

Bridge: "An AI agent is this party member: fast, tireless, never salty — and it does exactly what the quest says. You'll never out-grind it. You CAN out-lead it. Today you learn the leader's loop: quest card, roles, check the loot — then ship it or run it back."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE PARTY LEADER'S LOOP (10 MIN)

Write the loop on the board: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK**.

QUEST CARD. Four parts, in writing: **goal** (what winning means), **what we know** (who it's for, what the team already has), **rules of the run** (limits — length, tone, deadline), **done looks like** (the exact thing handed back). Prompt-writers: this is P.R.O. grown up.

ROLES. Leaders don't send one member to solo the raid. Split it: a **planner**, a **scout**, a **critic** — same card, one slice each.

CHECK THE LOOT. The leader checks **accuracy** (facts verified?), **taste** (fits the audience and vibe?), **done-ness** (everything the card asked for?).

SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK. Good work ships. Weak work gets a run-it-back note — keep + fix, specific enough that nobody guesses.

Model one quest card live on the board:

CURSED ORDER	PARTY LEADER'S QUEST CARD
"Plan the game night."	"GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. WHAT WE KNOW: Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. RULES OF THE RUN: school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. DONE LOOKS LIKE: one flyer draft, ready to photocopy."

Say it plainly: "Party leaders don't do the quest twice. If you have to redo a party member's work, your quest card failed. Fix the card, not just the work."

ACTIVITY — RUN THE QUEST (22 MIN)

- Write the quest card (6 min):** Teams of 3 pick a quest on the worksheet — Game Night page or zine issue #1 — and write ONE card with all four parts.
- Squad works (8 min):** Each teammate takes a role card — planner, scout, critic — and works ONLY from the quest card, silently, on their own paper. No questions: agents can't read minds. (In Sana's squad: DeShawn plans, Lucia scouts, Sana critiques.)
- Leader review (8 min):** Rotate — Sana reviews DeShawn, DeShawn reviews Lucia, Lucia reviews Sana. Each leader runs the CHECK rubric (worksheet p.2), rules SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK, and writes one run-it-back note.

EXIT TICKET (6 MIN)

Worksheet p.2: one complete quest card for a **real task in their own life** — all four parts labeled — something they'd actually hand an AI agent this week.

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Quest card sentence starters (Teacher Guide, p.2).
- Extension:** Write a card so tight the critic can't land a note — or invent a fourth squad role.
- ELL:** The four card labels double as language frames; draft in the strongest language first, then translate.
- No-device classrooms:** Built in — the teammates ARE the agents.
- With devices:** Run the team's card through a real AI tool and review ITS output with the same rubric.